FIELD PAPER · ENGLISH VERSION

Den Nye Fælled

The Church of Denmark as a holder of space for green transition, living soil, commons, lament, the sacred, and peaceful co-creation in Denmark

VERSION	DATE	STATUS	STEWARD
v0.5.1	12 October 2026	Working paper / field note	Lars A. Engberg

LANGUAGE	LICENSE
English	CC BY 4.0

EDITORIAL NOTE

This English Field Paper was developed in dialogue between the steward and AI language systems. The working method and responsibility are described in Methods / Editorial Practice.

ABSTRACT

This green paper proposes that, in the coming years, the Church of Denmark may step forward more clearly as a holder of space for green transition, living soil, commons practice, local peace practice, lament, human dignity, and an open meeting place between religious and non-religious forms of connectedness.

The paper suggests that the Church of Denmark stands in a particular moment of opening. It remains one of Denmark's most present institutions, with 4,217,476 members, corresponding to 70.0% of the population as of 1 January 2026, and it carries a nationwide local infrastructure of staff, volunteers, parish councils, buildings, and lands. At the same time, a concrete green movement is already underway through Folkekirkens Grønne Omstilling, with a focus that includes church lands, biodiversity, energy, waste, transport, procurement, and local collaborations.

Here Den Nye Fælled is proposed as a name for a possible Danish pilot field. This paper documents neither a selected place, an agreement with the Church of Denmark, nor a mandate to act on its behalf. The proposal is an open, non-proselytising space for collaboration in which a local parish and other participants, if they wish, can explore land, biodiversity, community, grief, and peaceful coexistence with clear agreements on access, responsibility, and decisions.

Methodologically, the paper begins with a place and the people and species affected. Local observations, specialist measurements, and institutional decisions should be able to meet without being collapsed into a single measure. The first movement may be a conversation or an inquiry into a place; it need not immediately involve cultivation. If a land-based trial later becomes possible, it needs a bounded site, willing participants, named accountable people, a question the place can answer, clarity about knowledge and uncertainty, and an agreed route for pause, correction, and useful return to the place.

01

Introduction: when an institution rediscovers its function

There are historical moments in which an institution is called not primarily to protect its form, but to rediscover its function.

The Church of Denmark, as this paper sees it, stands in such a moment.

The Church of Denmark — in Danish, *folkekirken* — remains deeply present in Denmark. Not only as buildings, rituals, and traditions, but as a living infrastructure of people, places, land, councils, employees, volunteers, practices, and rhythms. At the same time, it is clear that the Church of Denmark has become smaller in public consciousness than it really is. For many, it now appears primarily as a framework for baptism, weddings, funerals, holidays, and cultural heritage. All of this matters. But it does not exhaust what the church could be.

Beneath the surface, something is already moving. Green transition, church lands, biodiversity, night church, pilgrimage routes, local communities, open church rooms, and new forms of co-creation all point toward a shift in emphasis. Folkekirkens Grønne Omstilling itself describes church lands as a central focus area, and the Diocese of Helsingør connects green transition with local rootedness and renewal.

This green paper enters that opening with a question rather than a definition of the Church of Denmark from outside:

> *Can the Church of Denmark become a clearer holder of space for a new shared place in Denmark — a place where green transition,*

> *commons, peaceful co-creation, lament, the sacred, and human dignity may meet in practice?*

02

The problem field: a society running too hot

Several crises and upheavals converge in our time. Climate, biodiversity, soil, water, migration, mental strain, institutional mistrust, food systems, geopolitical unrest, and cultural polarization increasingly overlap.

Issues once treated separately are now often experienced as one dense, overheated field.

— Farmers and biologists often meet each other in mutual defensiveness.

— Citizens and institutions meet with mistrust.

— Schools struggle with well-being, pace, and overload.

— Migration and refugee questions are easily captured in administrative or ideological language.

— The church risks being seen only as a ceremonial institution while the society around it calls for something more alive.

What is missing is not primarily information. We need places where people can meet without immediately having to defend themselves, perform an identity, or fight over the narrative. What is missing are fields in which soil, care, rhythm, presence, and shared observation can come before positioning.

In this situation, the Church of Denmark has an opportunity: to host for an encounter that lowers the temperature and makes room for dignity and discovery.

03

The basic shift: speaking less, holding more space

> *The next phase in the Church of Denmark may be to speak less and hold more space.*

This is not a rejection of proclamation, theology, or liturgy. It is a shift in emphasis. In a society where people are already being explained, analysed, positioned, and persuaded from all sides, people may long for spaces where life can come into view before it is interpreted for them.

To hold space is not passivity. It is a discipline. Good hosting makes access, purpose, and boundaries clear: Who invites? Who has authority over the place? Who can say no, withdraw, or ask for a decision to be reconsidered? The church need not conceal its theological identity; participation in shared land practice must not require assent to faith or ritual.

— To sustain a gathering without taking it over.

— To let meaning emerge without forcing it.

— To hold the rhythm without dominating the content.

— To receive people without immediately trying to correct them.

Here the church may grow stronger by being more present: more hospitable, more attentive, more open to gathering in a circle, more rooted, more capable of holding a

field in which people may sit together, walk together, cultivate together, grieve together, listen together, and inquire together.

Late-night church gatherings, pilgrimage walks, and open church spaces already point in that direction as forms of practice in which presence, calm, and openness carry a substantial part of the room's meaning.

04

Moral Biology: ethics as capacity

Moral Biology offers one way to speak about this.

The term names a simple insight rather than a new ideology: that ethics is not only about what we believe, but also about what living systems can actually bear.

— Human beings are not only opinions. They are nervous systems.
— Communities are not only values. They are rhythms, atmospheres, and capacities.
— Institutions are not only rules. They are fields that either regulate or overload.

Sustained pressure can make conversation, attention, and relationships more fragile. People respond differently, and no bodily feeling alone can decide what is true or right for others. Green transition and the work of building social peace therefore depend on viable conditions as well as attitudes and policies.

This points toward something very concrete:

— that people need healthy roots,
— that places need living soil,
— that relationships need rhythm and decency,

— that institutions need forms that do not betray the life they are meant to serve.

There is also a more bodily layer here, one modern societies often underestimate. People can feel in their bodies some of what nourishes or depletes them. Aggression, chronic pressure, constant conflict, and brutality are not merely matters of opinion; they can also place a burden on the body. When a field becomes too harsh, people lose both nuance and breath. Peace is therefore a moral aspiration with a bodily dimension: the possibility of settling enough to remain present.

05

Healthy roots: a society's peace depends on rootedness

A recurring motif in this paper is the phrase *healthy roots*.

It points to something basic: people need to feel at home somewhere if they are not to become hardened, desperate, or unmoored. Home is not only property. Home is also participation, connection to a place, belonging, dignity, rhythm, and the possibility of contributing.

— When people lose roots, something happens to them.
— When local communities lose roots, something happens to them.
— When institutions lose roots, something happens to them.

Healthy roots therefore does not mean nostalgia. Nor does it mean romantic nationalism. It means creating the concrete conditions in which life can take root without becoming trapped.

— This applies to children in schools.
— It applies to stressed teachers.

— It applies to farmers who feel pushed into conflicts over identity.

— It applies to biologists who struggle to be heard without becoming targets of hostility.

— It applies to refugees and displaced people.

— It applies to priests and congregations.

— It applies to all of us.

And perhaps it is precisely here that the Church of Denmark may become a new kind of anchor institution: not by insisting on superiority, but by helping to restore roots.

06

Everyday life, pause, and the Danish feeling of habitat

There is also a more ordinary layer in this paper that should not be overlooked.

Many people in Denmark love everyday life. Not because everyday life is always easy, but because it carries a particular sense of home: the summer light, the shore, the garden, the coffee, the wind, the song of skylarks, the community close at hand, the temporary pause from noise. There is something deeply Danish in the longing for the ordinary, the close-to-home, and the quiet life, even while society is also marked by stress, performance pressure, and overheating.

This matters because green transition is often described in terms so large or so technical that one forgets what is actually at stake. It is not only about reduction targets, system design, and governance tools. It is also about whether people are able to breathe freely in their own lives. It matters whether there are places to rest before pressure takes over, and whether community feels like a habitat one wants to inhabit.

Here the Church of Denmark and the longing of many people may meet more deeply than is often said aloud. Not because everyone is religious. But because many people intuitively know that a society must also have places where ordinary life is nourished, and where there is room to pause again.

07

Church land: from asset to calling

One of the strongest concrete fields in this transition is church land.

Where a local church body has authority over a piece of land, it may be able to offer a place for shared use. Ownership, leases, existing uses, ecological duties, and lawful ways of making decisions must be clarified for the specific plot before anyone is invited to change it. Land is more than a resource. It can open space for encounter, learning, food practice, stillness, and shared observation. Yet species, water, history, and existing uses matter even where human activity should not expand. Protection, natural succession, different forms of care, or a well-founded decision not to intervene may matter as much as cultivation.

The church's own material points to new ways of caring for its land, including nature, ecological management, and woodland.

— Church land can be more than land attached to its buildings.

— It may become a living commons.

— A place where people meet around something that grows.

— A place where community can put down roots.

— A place where green transition can be felt and shared.

A small place may be enough to begin an inquiry, but the plot size does not determine its effects. Water, ecological corridors, neighbours, municipal decisions, and conservation duties may connect it to a larger landscape. What the place can carry must be considered within the relevant ecological and institutional setting.

08

Den Nye Fælled: a name, a pilot field, an invitation

Den Nye Fælled is proposed here as a name for a possible pilot field.

— Not as a legal entity.

— Not as a new church superstructure.

— Not as permanent branding.

But as a pilot name. An inviting name. A name that points toward a shared place where something new can begin.

Fælled is a Danish word for shared land, with a history of common use. It evokes cultivation, passage, conflict, use, and life together. The word is not tidy. It holds both the peaceful and the unresolved. That is precisely why the word is good. This movement is not about artificial harmony. It is about creating a field where people with different interests can meet without being forced back into the usual trenches.

What is new in Den Nye Fælled does not mean that everything old must go. It means that a new way of holding something in common is needed. A new commons. A new meeting place. Greater clarity about who belongs and who decides what.

— A place where the church can offer space or land without owning other people's experience or interpretations.

— A place where civil society may participate without capture.

— A place where soil, rhythm, ritual, observation, and peaceful co-creation may stand side by side.

09

A credible field: open boundaries and visible responsibility

In a field marked by disagreement over climate, migration, agriculture, religion, and public life, credibility must be built through visible responsibility and a real possibility of correction.

An open space is not free of power. The church holds property and organisational authority; other participants bring experience, needs, and their own boundaries. Caring for the field means making these differences visible and agreeing on how objections can have an effect.

— no party-political capture

— no proselytising takeover

— no special treatment for the well-connected

— no moral shaming as a method

— no branding that uses people as symbolic props

— no hidden economic power that drains trust

— no invitation to participate in decisions already made

If Den Nye Fælled is to be credible, hosts and participants need to show who decides what, how land and money are handled, how consent is obtained, and how someone can request a pause or correction without losing dignity.

That is also why an open and non-confessional collaborative field is a strength. Because the shared space is not a site for proselytising, the church and other participants can meet openly and with dignity.

10

A Danish pilot field

In this paper, Den Nye Fælled is a proposal for a Danish pilot field, situated within Danish institutions and the Church of Denmark. The paper describes a proposal, not a documented partnership.

Denmark, Greenland, and the Faroe Islands nevertheless stand in historical and political relations. Greenland and the Faroe Islands are situated within their own ecclesial, linguistic, political, and place-bound contexts. The paper therefore formulates neither needs nor solutions on their behalf and does not propose a common model across the Danish Realm.

Any future connection would need to grow through local relationships, on terms defined by the people in those places.

11

Shared earth, different places

Den Nye Fælled is a proposal for a Danish pilot field with planetary resonance. A place may also belong to a watershed, a species corridor, and a Danish institutional landscape of public authorities, rights, and duties to nature. No single scale can determine what should happen there next.

It is a local response to a planetary condition.

— We live on one planet.

— We are one humanity.

— We have no spare planet with which to bargain.

— We do not have another place to retreat to if living systems collapse.

And however different our cultures, religions, languages, historical experiences, and political systems may be, we share the most basic condition: we are living beings in a living shared system.

This does not mean that differences disappear. It does not mean that conflicts become irrelevant. It does not mean that history, power, and inequality should be smoothed away.

It means that beneath those differences there is a common denominator that cannot be negotiated away: air, water, soil, food, rhythm, rootedness, grief, care, boundaries, participation, and the need for places where life may be protected and nourished.

A planetary connection is not a mandate to act elsewhere. Experiences from Den Nye Fælled may be shared as an invitation, but not transferred as an imposition. Elsewhere, distinct forms must emerge through local relations, needs, and correction.

12

From planetary horizon to local action arenas

If Den Nye Fælled is to be more than a beautiful image, it must also be understood as a governance field.

It is not enough to say that we live on one planet, and that we are one humanity, if we do not at the same time ask how people actually learn to be with soil, habitat, and one another over time. For the common does not arise by itself. It is carried by practice, by boundaries, by knowledge, by local experience, and by the rules people develop together when they actually want a living field to endure.

Here Elinor Ostrom's work is decisive. Her studies of commons showed that in many places around the world people are in fact able to govern shared resources without either comprehensive state control or fragmentation into private ownership — but only when certain conditions are present. Ostrom's work shows the importance of boundaries, rules suited to the place, participation in changing those rules, observation, and accessible conflict resolution, among other things. The right arrangements here must be explored with those affected; design principles are not a ready-made organisational model for a church plot.

The same applies to habitat. As people spend time with a place's soil, species, water, seasons, and conditions of life, another kind of knowledge can emerge. It is a knowledge gained through participation rather than an overview from above. A person, a local community, or a steward circle learns something by being with a place long enough.

This understanding is not only theoretical. It is also lived. As a young PhD student, this paper's steward had the opportunity to meet Vincent and Elinor Ostrom at their home and in their academic circle. What made a lasting impression was not only their concepts, but their way of being: hospitable, warm, precise, and welcoming. The way they met people reflected what they studied: hospitality, care, and attention to how people live together. Commons here became not only an analytical field, but also a practice of decency, attention, and generosity. That connection between thought and lived practice matters to Den Nye Fælled.

Vincent Ostrom's work on polycentric governance also matters here. Complex systems need not be governed from a single centre; several autonomous bodies can coordinate

their work. Den Nye Fælled can be read in that tradition as a possible local arena where church authority, other legitimate rights, specialist knowledge, and the ecological limits of the place meet without becoming a single mandate. The church may host, but decisions about land use belong to those who can lawfully and legitimately make them, with a way for those affected to raise objections.

> *Den Nye Fælled is not merely a meeting place. It is a place to practise living together more wisely.*

— to be with the earth without exhausting it,

— to be with one another without immediately going to war,

— to be with difference without losing common ground,

— and to be with the living without reducing it to service alone.

13

Refugees, sense of home, and peace practice

One of the places where this line of thought deepens is in the encounter with refugees and displaced people.

Far too often, people who have fled are reduced to administrative cases, political arguments, or symbols. But at a more basic level, their situation is also about the need for a place to belong, bodily safety, participation, and dignity.

Here Den Nye Fælled and the church's hosting function may open another possibility.

— Not as paternalistic aid.

— Not as a naïve fantasy of harmony.

— But as shared practice around soil, food systems, biodiversity, local community, and regenerative participation.

If people willingly meet around land, food, observation, rhythm, or season, a different kind of relation may grow than one created through administration or debate alone. Nobody should be invited as a representative of “refugees” or turned into evidence for an integration story; the people concerned must be free to decide whether shared practice makes sense for them.

Such encounters may also be part of making peace.

14

Farmers, biologists, and the porch

The church entrance offers a vivid image here.

The Danish *våbenhus*, the church entrance hall, recalls a place where weapons were once left before entering. That image still speaks to the present.

Danish society is full of fields in which people meet one another carrying symbolic weapons. Not least in the relationship between agriculture, nature, biodiversity, climate, and governance. Very quickly, people arrive representing positions: one defending, the other accusing, and both already armed.

But if people meet on shared ground with a different kind of host, something may change. The temperature may fall. The land may become a shared point of attention. Yet a plot does not dissolve disagreement about production, protection, access, or property.

Hosting succeeds if different interests can meet around the actual place and their differences lead to better questions and legitimate decisions.

15

Citizen science as shared ground

The wider work behind this proposal has developed a simple, open approach to citizen science. The point is not to turn everyone into experts, but to make the field more legible to more people.

When people are able to observe a place together — soil, water, growth, biodiversity, small changes, well-being — they can find common ground without first agreeing on a worldview.

Shared observation can become a practice of democratic attention when those who know the place can shape both the question and its interpretation. Species records, soil tests, and lived experience may correct one another, but no single measure of biodiversity or well-being tells the whole story of a place. Record the method, date, uncertainty, and how someone can challenge a conclusion; do not let data travel without agreed access and a useful return to those who made the work possible. If church authorities, researchers, or supporters seek access, they must shape their questions and documentation around the consent and capacity of those involved. Local participants should not have to turn private grief or situated knowledge into reporting material to be heard.

It becomes a useful beginning only when it is clear who receives an observation, who has the authority to respond, and how any action, resources, and later consequences will

be followed up. A species list is not a verdict on an ecosystem; recording is not consent; and publication alone is not a return to the place.

16

Penguin Economics: rotation, replenishment, and fair burden-sharing

If such a field is to endure, the people and the work need an economy that can sustain them.

Here the logic of Penguin Economics matters: rotation rather than hoarding, replenishment rather than exhaustion, burden-sharing rather than invisible overload.

— Good work often falters because too few people carry it.
— Idealism can falter without a sustainable economic rhythm.
— Communities can become lopsided when some give everything and others only receive.

Den Nye Fælled must therefore ask whether its economy protects the people and life of the place. Before a trial begins, the responsible circle should ask who cares for the place, how much time it takes, who pays necessary costs, and when volunteering becomes an invisible burden. Ongoing care and responsibility must not silently be assumed to rely on volunteers. Before a trial begins, those concerned should agree which functions are voluntary, which require wages or contractual payment, and how the funds will be secured. Ecological improvement cannot cancel out human exhaustion; a church budget cannot by itself demonstrate ecological improvement. If support, time, knowledge, or hospitality ever moves outward from the field, that happens only when those concerned

agree freely and have the capacity to do so. Receiving help creates no duty to pass anything on.

17

The Church of Denmark as anchor institution in a new time

The Church of Denmark has a particular opportunity now.

— It is not only cultural history.

— It is not only public administration.

— It is not only religious service.

Few institutions combine a local presence, ritual life, historical continuity, room for people, and a capacity to host. The Church of Denmark itself states that it employs more than 12,000 staff and is supported by several thousand volunteers.

If the Church of Denmark enters more deeply into this hosting function, it can examine its role as an anchor institution: less concerned with prestige as superiority, more concerned with credibility as presence. The test also applies to the church itself. The church's own practice concerning land, labour, access, and decisions must be open to change in light of what local people and places show. That could mean giving more room to silence, circles, soil, and shared practice alongside preaching.

When confirmation students are able to stay overnight in a church and experience the room as marked by calm, safety, and trust, it says something important about what the church may still be. Not only a place for words and ritual, but a place that holds. Such a space is more than symbolic; it can help people feel safe and settle together. Amid unrest and conflict, that capacity is itself a resource for society.

Lament as infrastructure: the Church of Denmark and the public capacity for grief

Grief still receives too little attention in green, social, and institutional change.

— Not grief as private weakness.

— Not grief as a sentimental pause from the “real” work.

— But grief as a possible and important part of living correction.

When people, local communities, and institutions live under prolonged pressure, conflict and misunderstanding are not the only things that accumulate. Grief does too.

If the Church of Denmark is to become a holder of space for green transition, living soil, and peaceful co-creation, it must also be able to hold space for lament. Not as another sermon about suffering, but as a space where people can breathe, weep, be silent, listen, and stay together with what hurts, without being hurried onward. There should be room for grief for those who need it; participation does not require grieving or sharing anything private.

> *Lament is not the opposite of action. Lament can make action more honest.*

— Den Nye Fælled must therefore also be a place of slowness.

— A place of silence.

— A place of tears.

— A place of breath.

— A place where people meet not only around what is to grow, but also around what has already been lost.

19

The sacred without monopoly: an open field on church land

Den Nye Fælled is not imagined as a narrowly religious or confessional space.

This does not mean that the field is empty of spirit, depth, or holiness. Nor does it mean that the religious is pushed away. It means that the field should not be closed by one particular right of interpretation.

There must be places in a society where the religious and the non-religious may meet on common ground without one form having to absorb the other.

Here, the sacred points first to what must be cared for, not to dogma. It is what must be protected because it carries life. It may be soil. It may be a human being's boundaries. It may be grief. It may be silence. It may be a shared room where decency, rhythm, and presence are allowed to stand without being invaded.

The value of a species or habitat does not depend on whether it offers people food, recreation, or religious experience. Calling something sacred does not confer a mandate to speak on behalf of a place or other people. In this sense, the sacred must not be monopolized. It must be able to be met, shared, and practiced in different forms without emptying the shared space of meaning.

Holding space likewise names a particular kind of hosting: not merely to arrange a meeting, but to protect the conditions in which people may be present without immediately being explained, judged, mobilized, or corrected.

20

Pilot tracks

At Assistens Cemetery, people leave ballpoint pens at Dan Turèll's grave. No one asked for it. No one administers it. It is love finding a form — a closeness to intimate things, the poetry of ordinary life in the open air.

It may be as close as we come to defining sanctuary: a place where nature, culture, and the realities of life have room to be, for each person and within a shared field.

Perhaps that kind of attention is where a first place begins.

If this paper points toward concrete first movements, they could be these. The five tracks are possibilities for conversation, not agreements with a diocese, parish, or any of the other people mentioned:

PILOT TRACK 1

A conversation in Helsingør. Helsingør appears as an obvious first point of contact because green transition is already clearly present there, and because the leadership of the diocese stands at the intersection of ecclesial responsibility and green movement.

PILOT TRACK 2

A possible site near a parish church. A site near a church could be explored as a first shared place. Before choosing it, learn about its existing ecology, uses, rights, and connections to water and neighbouring places. Perhaps the best beginning is to protect what already lives there.

PILOT TRACK 3

Circles and field-holding. Not only meetings outdoors, but also circles in which priests, citizens, young people, farmers, teachers, refugees, or others may be together without immediately having to deliver solutions.

PILOT TRACK 4

Citizen science and shared documentation. A simple observation practice can connect local knowledge and relevant expertise with a response from someone authorised to act. It should gather only what the next decision actually needs and make both disagreement and uncertainty visible.

PILOT TRACK 5

Regenerative peace practice. Food forest experiments, habitat areas, shared cultivation, and care may be explored as concrete peace practice where they fit the local ecology, existing use, and participants' own motivation.

Delimitations and risks

A first step could be one invitation to talk and a shared examination of one possible place. Before a plot becomes a trial site, the relevant church authority clarifies who controls the land, any leases, and the legal conditions. The municipality and relevant specialists are involved where the place requires them. People affected can choose whether to participate. Together, participants agree on a bounded question and a revisable account of the site's starting conditions: soil, water, species, existing uses, and the time needed to care for it. They name who is responsible for decisions, care, and money, set a date for joint review, and agree on a way to pause. The first hypothesis must be open to challenge by what the place shows. An observation or photograph is shared only when there is a sound basis and the necessary consent. After a season, results, errors, and open questions are brought back to the participants before being used in a wider account. If sound existing care already works, if the place is better left to develop with less intervention, or if nobody can sustain maintenance, the proposed programme must be allowed to fall away. A trial that cannot carry this modest rhythm must be able to end with dignity.

This paper is not blind to risk.

— There is a risk that the field becomes too diffuse.

— There is a risk that church actors experience it as too open.

— There is a risk that people outside the church experience it as too closely tied to the church.

— There is a risk of capture, prestige games, branding, or well-meant overreach, even when intentions are good.

— There is a risk that old patterns simply repeat themselves in new language.

Everything must therefore begin small, calm, and honest. No one should be persuaded too quickly. Nothing should grow faster than it can bear.

> *Gold before flowering. Roots before crown. Field before scale.*

22

Invitation to conversation, pilot, and shared inquiry

This paper is not a demand for theological restructuring. It is not a party-political programme. It is not a finished project proposal with every answer already in place.

It is an invitation.

— An invitation to conversation.

— An invitation to inquire whether the Church of Denmark, in this time, may carry a deeper hosting function.

— An invitation to test small, local, and learning-oriented pilot forms.

— An invitation to let soil, rhythm, grief, silence, observation, and peaceful coexistence take concrete form in a shared field.

If this paper speaks to an opening in the Church of Denmark today, the next step need not be a large programme. The next step is a conversation, a chance to listen and explore whether a first shared place is possible.

23

Conclusion: an invitation to hold a new place

This paper is not written to tell the Church of Denmark what it should become.

It is written to point toward the fact that an opening already exists.

— An opening toward more soil.

— More hosting.

— More silence.

— More shared ground.

— More living responsibility.

— More room for people to meet without being seized by the usual mechanisms.

The Church of Denmark cannot solve everything. But it may be able to help hold a place where more may begin.

That place could be Den Nye Fælled.

— Not as a system.

— Not as slogan.

— Not as programmatic imposition.

— But as a place with open boundaries and responsibility.

A field in which soil, ritual, neighbour-love, citizen science, biodiversity, peace work, commons, lament, the sacred, and human dignity may stand alongside one another without having to melt into a single ideology.

> *A field where human beings may once again come into view as human beings. Before they become roles. Before they become conflicts. Before they become arguments.*

If the Church of Denmark is willing to help hold such a field, it will be an act of ecological care, social connection, and peace, rooted in a particular place. It will answer the times with something other than more noise.

And in a time like this, that is not a small thing.

HOW THIS PAPER MAY BE CITED

Engberg, L. A. (2026). *Den Nye Fælled: The Church of Denmark as a holder of space for green transition, living soil, commons, lament, the sacred, and peaceful co-creation in Denmark*. Green Papers: Notes Toward Planetary Guardianship (v0.5.1, 12 October 2026). Spiralweb Papers. CC BY 4.0.

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

- Folkekirken. Statistics on the Church of Denmark: membership figures as of 1 January 2026.
- Folkekirkens Grønne Omstilling. Background, focus areas, and practice fields.
- Diocese of Helsingør. Material on green diocese, local rootedness, and green transition.
- Church of Denmark. Organisational descriptions of employees and volunteers.
- Ostrom, E. (1990). *Governing the Commons*.
- Ostrom, V. (1972/1999 et seq.). Works on polycentric governance.
- Spiralweb Papers (2026). *Det levende felt / The Living Field*; *Levende landskaber / Living Landscapes*; *At holde jorden levende*; *Knowing From the Ground*; *Land, Water and Living*

Stewardship; *Regenerative Reciprocity*; *Authority, Pause, Refusal and Correction*; and *Rule of Life*. Related inquiries, not evidence of a local partnership.